MIL-H-43577D
31 December 1984
SUPERSEDING
MIL-H-43577C
14 May 1974

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

HATS, SUN, HOT WEATHER

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers hats made of cotton material.

* 1.2 Classification. The hat shall be of three types in the following sizes (see 6.2).

Type I	-	Olive Green 107; 2-3/8-inch width brim
Type II	-	Camouflage Pattern; 3-inch width brim
Type III	-	Woodland Camouflage Pattern; 2-3/8-inch width brim

Schedule of sizes

6-3/8	6-7/8	7-3/8
6-1/2	7	7-1/2
6-5/8	7-1/8	7-5/8
		7-3/4
6-3/4	7-1/4	7-7/8

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8415

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

* 2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specefied herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

V-L-61	-	Laces, Nylon
V-T-276	-	Thread, Cotton
KK-L-271	-	Leather, Cattlehide, Strap, Vegetable Tanned
DDD-L-20	-	Label; For Clothing,, Equipage, and Tentage, (General Use)
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-C-342	-	Cloth, Wind Resistant, Poplin, Cotton
MIL-T-3530	-	Thread and Twine; Mildew Resistant or Water Repellent Treated
MIL-C-43468	-	Cloth, Camouflage Pattern: Wind Resistant Poplin, Cotton
MIL-T-43458	-	Thread, Polyester Cotton Covered and Rayon Covered
MIL-W-43668	-	Webbing, Textile, Bulked Nylon
MIL-C-43836	-	Cloth, Interlining, Nonwoven

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-751	-	Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147	-	Palletized Unit Loads

(Copies of documents required by manufacturers in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

* 2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

* 2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

* 3.1 Guide samples. Samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variation from this document may appear in the sample, in which case this document shall govern.

3.2 Materials.

3.2.1 Basic materials.

3.2.1.1 Type I hat. The basic material shall be cotton rip-stop poplin cloth, quarpel treated, dyed Olive Green 107 and conforming to class B of MIL-C-342.

3.2.1.2 Type II hat. The basic material shall be cotton rip-stop poplin cloth, camouflage pattern, conforming to type II of MIL-C-43468.

* 3.2.1.3 Type III hat. The basic material shall be cotton rip-stop poplin cloth, woodland camouflage pattern, conforming to type III of MIL-C-43468.

3.2.2 Brim binding. The brim binding shall be bias-cut from the basic materials (see 3.2.1) applicable to the type hat required (see 6.2).

3.2.3 Brim interlining and head-band stay piece. The brim interlining and head-band stay piece shall be white, nonwoven, continuous filament polyester cloth conforming to type I, class 2 of MIL-C-43836.

* 3.2.4 Webbing, nylon. The nylon webbing for the camouflage band shall be bulked nylon, type IV, 3/4 inch wide, conforming to MIL-W-43668. The webbing shall be dyed Olive Green 106. The dyed webbing shall show fastness to laundering and light, equal to or better than the standard sample. When no standard sample is available, the dyed webbing shall show "good" fastness to laundering and light.

3.2.5 Laces, nylon. The nylon lace for the chin strap shall be Olive Green 106 conforming to type II, class 2, 8/32 inch wide of V-L-61 except that the requirements for length and tipping shall not apply.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.6 Keeper, leather. The leather for the chinstrap keeper shall conform to any type, class 2 of KK-L-271 except that the requirements for colorfastness, breaking force, elongation, total ash and degree of tannage shall not apply. The thickness of the leather shall be 6/64 to 8/64 inch and the color shall be natural as produced by the tanning agents. The finish shall be smooth and have a natural gloss appearance.

* 3.2.7 Thread. The thread for stitching the hat shall be cotton, soft finish, type IA3, ticket No. 50, 3 ply and ticket No. 70, 2 ply conforming to V-T-276 or polyester, cotton covered or rayon covered thread, ticket No. 50 and ticket No. 70 conforming to MIL-T-43548. The thread shall be water repellent treated to conform to type II, class 3 of MIL-T-3530.

3.2.7.1 Color and colorfastness. The thread shall be dyed Shade S-1, C.A. 66022 and shall show fastness to laundering and light equal to or better than the standard sample. When no standard sample is available, the dyed thread shall show "good" fastness to laundering and light.

* 3.2.8 Labels. Each hat shall have a combination identification-size label conforming to type IV, class 4 of DDD-L-20 and an instruction label conforming to type IV, class 3 of DDD-L-20. The labels shall show fastness to laundering. The instruction label shall measure not more than 2 inches by 2 inches and shall include the following information.

CAUTION

Initial loose fit required
for continued comfort.

LAUNDERING

Spot wash badly soiled areas.

Wash in hot water (140°F) using
soap or detergent.

Rinse at least 3 times to restore
water repellency.

Machine spin or squeeze by hand.

Machine dry at moderate heat or
hang to dry.

Do not starch.

DO NOT REMOVE THIS LABEL

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.9 Ventilators, with washers. The screen type ventilators with washers shall be brass, black chemical, 9/16 inch outside rim diameter, and 7/16 inch outside diameter screening, conforming to Stimpson Company, #53 or equal (see 6.4). Prior to use of the "or equal" item, the contractor shall submit the item to the contracting officer, with supporting data, for approval.

3.3 Design. The design shall be as shown on figure 1.

3.4 Patterns. Patterns which provide an allowance for all seams, will be furnished by the Government to the contractor for cutting working patterns. Neither the Government patterns nor the working patterns shall be altered in any way. Seam allowances shall be as follows:

Side lining to crown	- 3/16 inch
Top side to crown, back seams, top side to bottom side	- 1/4 inch
Brim to sides	- 3/8 inch

* 3.4.1 List of pattern parts. The components of the hat shall be cut from materials specified according to the pattern parts indicated in table I.

TABLE I. Pattern parts

Material	Pattern nomenclature	Cut parts
Basic material	Top crown	1
	Top side	1
	Bottom side	1
	Top and Bottom Side Crown (Alternate construction)	1
	Side lining	1
	Top brim (type I and type III hats) 1/	1
	Top brim (type II hat) 2/	1
	Bottom brim (type I and type III hats) 1/	1
	Bottom brim (type II hat) 2/	1
Nonwoven material	Brim interlining (type I and type III hats)	1
	Brim interlining (type II hat)	1
	Headband stay	1

1/ Same pattern part.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2/ Same pattern part.

3.5 Construction.

* 3.5.1 Stitches, seams and stitching. Stitch, seam and stitching types specified in table II shall conform to FED-STD-751. Where two or more seam or stitch types are given for the same part of an operation, any one of them may be used. When stitch type 401 is used, the looper (underthread) shall be on the inside of the hat. Seam allowances shall be maintained with seams sewn so that raw edges, run offs, twists, pleats or puckers will not result. All seams shall start and finish evenly. Ends of a continuous line of stitching shall be overlapped not less than 1/2 inch. The ends of the label stitching shall be overlapped not less than three stitches.

* 3.5.1.1 Type 301 stitching. Ends of all seams and stitching when not caught in other seams or stitching shall be bartacked not less than 1/4 inch. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching resulting in loose bobbin or top thread, or excessively tight stitching resulting in puckering of the materials sewn.

* 3.5.1.1.1 Repairs of type 301 stitching. Repairs of type 301 stitching shall be as follows:

a. When thread breaks or bobbin run-outs occur during sewing, the stitching shall be repaired by restarting the stitching a minimum of 1/2 inch back of the end of the stitching. 1/

b. Thread breaks or two or more consecutive skipped or run-off stitches noted during inspection of the item shall be repaired by over-stitching. The stitching shall start a minimum of 1/2 inch in back of the defective area, continue over the defective area, and continue a minimum of 1/2 inch beyond the defective area on to the existing stitching. Loose or excessively tight stitching shall be repaired by removing the defective stitching, without damaging the materials, and restitching in the required manner. 1/

1/ When making the above repairs the ends of the stitching are not required to be back stitched.

* 3.5.1.2 Types 101, 401, and 701 stitching. Thread tension shall be maintained so that there will be no loose stitching. All repairs shall be in accordance with 3.5.1.1.1a and 3.5.1.1.1b. Repairs to stitch type 401 may be accomplished by use of stitch type 301.

3.5.2 Stitches per inch. The minimum and maximum number of stitches per inch shall be as specified in table II.

3.6 Manufacturing operations requirements. The hat shall be made in accordance with the operation requirements specified in table II. The

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

contractor is not required to follow the exact sequence of operations listed, unless otherwise specified. Seam allowances required to be turned and seam turn-up of side and lining may be precreased. Any additional basting or holding stitches used to facilitate manufacture are permissible provided the thread does not show on the finished hat.

3.6.1 Figure. Figure 1 is furnished for information purposes only. If there are any inconsistencies between the written document and the figure, the written document shall control.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II.

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
1.	Cutting.						
	a. Cut all parts in strict accordance with patterns furnished which show size, directional lines (warp or filling direction) and notches for proper assembly of all parts.						
	b. Cut basic material parts of hat from one piece of material except brim binding and side lining which may be cut from ends. The side lining and brim binding, when cut from ends, shall approximate the shade or color pattern of the respective basic material.						
	c. Cut the brim binding on the bias, not less than 1-1/8 inches wide. Brim binding may be placed on rolls.						
	d. Cut the lace for the chin strap with a heated blade to fuse ends of straps. The cut lengths shall be 25 inches ± 1 inch.						
2.	Replacement of damaged parts.						
	Care shall be exercised during the spreading, cutting, and manufacturing operations to assure that material defects and damages, as classified in 4.2.2, are excluded and replaced with non-defective and properly matched material.						
3.	Marking.						
	a. Mark, ticket or bundle all cut parts to insure a uniform shade, color pattern and size throughout the the hat.						

NATICK Form 903
1 Dec 76 EDITION OF 1 OCT 76 WILL BE USED UNTIL EXHAUSTED.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. (cont'd)

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
3.	Marking. (cont'd)						
	b. Any method of marking may be used except:						
	(1) Metal fastening devices. (2) Sew-on tickets. (3) Adhesive type tickets which leave traces of adhesive on the material after removal of the tickets.						
4.	Make chin strap keeper and chin strap.						
	a. Cut leather piece for chin strap keeper, 3/4 ± 1/8 inch long by 1/2 ± 1/8 inch wide.						
	b. Punch two holes, equally spaced, in keeper to accomodate chin strap. The holes shall be of sufficient length and width to insure proper function of the keeper, i.e., keeper shall not move without exertion of a slight pressure.						
	c. Thread chin strap through holes in keeper.						
5.	Make brim.						
	Finished appearance. The brim shall be made of two plies of basic material interlined with one ply of nonwoven material and shall finish without twists or puckers. The brim shall be quilted with parallel lines of stitching and shall finish in the applicable width specified in table III and finish with an upward curl.						
	a. (1) Superimpose outside edges of bottom brim and brim interlining with notches matching, and stitch together 1/16 to 1/8 inch from outside edges.	101 or 301 or 401	SSa-1	6-i4	50 50 50	 50 70	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NO.	TABLE II (cont'd) MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
5.	Make brim. (cont'd)						
	(2) Superimpose outside edges of top brim and brim interlining with notches matching and stitch 1/16 to 1/8 inch from outside edges through all plies.	101 or 301 or 401	SSa-1	6-14	50 50 50	 50 70	
				or			
	b. Superimpose outside edges of bottom brim, brim interlining, and top brim with notches matching and stitch together 1/16 to 1/8 inch from outside edges in one operation.	101 or 301 or 40	SSa-1	6-14	50 50 50	 50 70	
	c. Stitch bottom brim to top brim along inner edge adjacent to brim interlining.	301	SSa-1	8-10	50	50	
	d. Single or double stitch brim plies together with the row of stitches starting from outside edge of brim and continue stitching for the entire brim width. The rows of stitching shall be spaced 3/16 inch to 1/4 inch apart. The needle thread shall finish on top brim in the finished hat.	301		8-10	50	50	
*	e. Turn under one end of binding 1/4 inch and superimpose edges of binding on underside of brim and stitch binding to outside edge of brim 3/16 to 1/4 inch from edge, holding binding tight. The binding shall start and finish at center back (± 1/2 inch tolerance) with the turned end of binding lapped not less than 1/2 inch on opposite end of binding.	301 or 401	BSg-(a)	10-14	50 50	50 70	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil - Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II (cont'd)

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
5.	Make brim. (cont'd)						
	f. Turn binding over edge of brim, turn in raw edge and stitch 1/16 to 3/32 inch from edge through binding and brim. Binding shall finish not more than 3/8 inch wide on top side of brim, and shall be attached so that the brim will curve upward 3/4 to 1 inch for type I and type III hats and 1 to 1-1/8 inches for type II hat.	301	BSg-2(b)	10-14	50	50	
	or						
	As an alternate the binding may be attached to the brim in one operation using a folder.						
6.	Join sides and camouflage band.						
	a. Join top side to bottom side with front notches matching.	301 or 401	LSq-2(a)	10-14	50 50	50 70	
	b. Turn down bottom side and raise stitch bottom side, 1/16 to 3/32 inch from outside edge.	301 or	LSq-2(b)	10-14	50	50	
	or						
	Alternate construction						
	Finished appearance. The finished mock seam shall be uniform in width, without distortion, and be accomplished only by use of a folder.						
	c. Position side piece in folder, pass piece through folder in accordance with marks on pattern. The outside folded edge of the mock seam shall face the top of the crown with the stitching 1/8 inch from the folded edge.	301 or 401	OSE-1	10-14 10-14	50 50	50 70	
	d. Cut nylon webbing of sufficient length to meet the following requirements:						

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NO.	TABLE II (cont'd) MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
6.	Join sides and camouflage band. (cont'd)						
	1. Bartack the webbing around the circumference of the hat and centered (1/8 inch tolerance on the bottom side piece. Bartacks shall be positioned 1-1/4 ± 1/8 inches apart with one bartack located at center front. The webbing shall be attached to the side piece with 1/8 inch fullness (-0 + 1/8 inch tolerance) between bartacks forming loops. No bartack shall finish closer than 1/2 inch from back seam. The bartacks shall extend widthwise across the webbing and measure 1/2 to 5/8 inch in length and the width shall not exceed 3/32 inch. Bartacks shall not extend off edges of webbing.	Bartack or 701		28 per bartack 28 per tack	50 50	50	
	2. Prestitch ends of webbing to back seam allowance to finish with 1/8 inch fullness (-0 + 1/8 inch tolerance) of the back loop after joining center back seam.	101 or 301 or 401			50 50 50	50 70	
	3. Join center back seam of top and bottom sides sides catching ends of webbing in the stitching. Open seam allowances and stitch through the turned edges 1/16 to 3/32 inch from each side of joining seam line.	301 or 401 and 301	SSa-1 SSz-3(b) shows finished seam	10-14 10-14	50 50 50	50 70 50	
	e. Position the instruction label 3/4 to 1 inch from the back raw edge of the left side lining as worn on the inside of the hat. Stitch label on all four sides. The stitching shall not be through the printing.	301	LSbj-1	10-14	50	50	
	f. Join center back seam of side lining and open seam allowances.	301 or 401	SSa-1	10-14	50 50	50 70	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NO.	TABLE II (cont'd) MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
7.	Join sides to crown.						
	Finished appearance. The top side piece shall finish on top of crown and shall be free of twists, puckers, pleats or raw edges.						
	a. Join side lining to inside of crown, matching front notches and with back seam in line with back notch on crown. Stitching shall not show on outside.	101 or 301 or 401	SSa-1	10-14	50 50 50	 50 70	
	b. Join top side to outside of crown, matching front notches and with back seam in line with back notch on crown.	301 or 401	LSbp-2(a)	10-14	50 50	50 70	
	c. Turn down top side and raise stitch 1/16 to 3/32 inch from edge.	301	LSbp-2(b)	10-14	50	50	
	NOTE: The stitchings, specified in operation b and c shall not show on inside of hat.						
8.	Join sides to brim.						
	a. Position ends of chin strap to underside of brim at each side notch and tack in position.	301 or 401 or Bartack		6-14	50 50 50	50 70 50	
	b. Position bottom side piece to top of brim matching front notches and back seam in line with back notch of brim and raw edges even and stitch side piece to brim, not through brim interlining.	301 or 401	LSq-2(a)	10-14	50 50	50 70	
	c. Turn up bottom side piece and edge stitch 1/16 to 3/32 inch from edge.	301 or 401	LSq-2(b)	10-14	50 50	50 70	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

NO.	TABLE II (cont'd) MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	STITCHING TYPE	PER INCH	NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
8.	Join sides to brim. (cont'd)						
	d. Position headband stay piece to inside of side lining with bottom edge of stay piece 1/2 inch from bottom edge of lining and with back edges of stay piece butted and in line with back seam of lining. Stitch top edge of stay piece to lining 1/16 to 1/8 inch from edge of stay piece.	301 or 401	LSq-2(a)	10-14		50 50	
	e. Turn up bottom raw edge of lining over bottom edge of stay piece.						
	f. Position side lining to bottom of brim matching front notches and back seam in line with back notch of brim, 1/16 to 3/32 inch from turned edge, catching bottom edge of size label in the stitching. The label shall extend upward into the crown and positioned to right side of center back seam.	301	LSq-2(b)	10-14	50	50	
	NOTE: The lining shall not be full or twisted on the finished hat nor shall it twist or cause fullness to the outside of the finished hat. The lining shall not extend below the brim.						
9.	Blocking.						
	Block crown on proper sized heated blocks and flange brims with metal dies on hydraulic press with heat and pressure to properly set brims.						
10.	Attach ventilators.						
	Pre-punch holes through side and lining, as indicated by marks on pattern, and attach a ventilator at each hole with washer on inside of hat.						

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II (cont'd)

NO.	MANUFACTURING OPERATIONS REQUIREMENTS	STITCH TYPE	SEAM AND STITCHING TYPE	STITCHES PER INCH	THREAD		
					NEEDLE	BOBBIN/ LOOPER	COVER
11	Clean hats. a. Trim all thread ends. b. Remove all loose threads, spots, stains, shade or color pattern and size markings.						

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.7 Measurements. The finished measurements of the hat shall conform to table III for each size.

TABLE III. Finished measurements (in inches)

Size	Inside hat (head measurements 1/	Crown height at center front 2/	Crown height at center back 3/	Brim width 4/
6-3/8	20-1/2	2-3/4	3-1/2	2-3/8
6-1/2	20-7/8	all sizes	all sizes	all sizes (type I and type III hat)
6-5/8	21-1/4			
6-3/4	21-5/8			
6-7/8	22			3
7	22-3/8			all sizes (type II hat)
7-1/8	22-3/4			
7-1/4	23-1/8			
7-3/8	23-1/2			
7-1/2	23-7/8			
7-5/8	24-1/4			
7-3/4	24-5/8			
7-7/8	25			
Tolerance	± 1/4	± 1/4	± 1/4	± 1/8

1/ Measure along bottom edge of side lining.

2/ From base of side to crown seam on outside of center front.

3/ From base of side to crown seam on outside of center back.

4/ From base of side to outer bound edge of brim.

3.8 Workmanship. The finished hats shall conform to the quality of product established by this document. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the document where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

* 4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1 components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.2.1.1 Certification. The contractor shall furnish a certificate of compliance for the nonwoven materials specified in 3.2.3 and the ventilator specified in 3.2.9.

* 4.2.2 End item visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one hat. The sample unit shall be one hat. The inspection level shall be II and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5 for major defects, 10.0 for major and minor A combined defects, and 15.0 for total (major, minor A and minor B combined) defects.

Defects	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Blocking			
a. Omitted.	X		
b. Poorly blocked, causing distortion on crown or brim; hat not symmetrical, affecting appearance.		X	
Cleanness			
a. Any spot or stain on outside.			X
b. Thread ends not trimmed, loose threads, or one or more shade, color pattern or size marking not removed.			X
c. Shade stamp marking (when used for type I hat only) exposed on outside.		X	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Defects	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Component and assembly			
a. Any component part or required operation omitted (unless otherwise classified herein).	X		
b. Any operation not performed as specified (unless otherwise classified herein).			X
Cutting			
Any part not cut in accordance with directional lines indicated on pattern or not cut in accordance with document requirements.	X		
Ventilators			
a. One or more omitted or added.	X		
b. Broken or bent.	X		
c. One or more improperly clinched, i.e., loose or raw edges exposed around edges of ventilator on outside.	X		
d. One or more not properly clinched, i.e., raw edges of lining exposed around edges of ventilator on inside.			X
e. Side puckered, pleated, or full in clinching one or more ventilators.		X	
f. One or more ventilators with washer on outside.	X		
Labels (identification-size and instruction)			
a. Missing, incorrect, or illegible.	X		
b. Not securely attached.		X	
Material defects and workmanship damages			
a. Any hole or shade bar.	X		
b. Any defect such as a smash, multiple float, or slub.	X		
c. Cut, tear, rip, mend, or burn.	X		
d. Needle chew.	X		
Seams and stitching			
a. General:			
1. Seam twisted, puckered, or pleated.		X	
2. Part of hat caught in any unrelated operation or stitching.	X		

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Defects	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Seams and stitching (cont'd)			
3. Thread(s) used on outside not same shade or not specified shade.	X		
4. End of seam (except continuous line of stitching) when not caught in other seam stitching backtacked less than 1/4 inch.		X	
5. End of continuous line of stitching overlapped less than 1/2 inch, unless otherwise specified.		X	
6. Thread break (all stitch types) stitched less than 1/2 inch beyond each end of break.			X
b. Gage of stitching and seam allowances:			
1. Irregular, i.e., unevenly gaged, or corresponding stitching not uniformly gaged (to be scored only when condition exists along major portion of seam).		X	
2. Width not as specified or not within range of gage specified or varies more than 1/16 inch when no range is specified.			X
3. Edge or raised stitching sewn too close to edge resulting in damage to cloth.	X		
NOTE: The above defects to be scored only when the condition exists on major portion (i.e., over the half or more) of seam.			
c. Open seams (one or more broken or two or more skipped or runoff stitches constitute an open seam):			
1. Any seam open on outside:			
- up to 1/4 inch inclusive		X	
- more than 1/4 inch.	X		
2. Any seam open on inside of hat:			
- up to 1/4 inch inclusive			X
- more than 1/4 inch to 1 inch inclusive		X	
- more than 1 inch.	X		
d. Raw edges:			
1. Any raw edge on outside of hat:			
- 1/4 to 1/2 inch inclusive		X	
- more than 1/2 inch	X		
2. Any raw edge on inside of hat more than 1/4 inch.			X

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Defects	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Seams and stitching (cont'd)			
NOTE: Raw edges not securely caught in stitching shall be classified as an open seam.			
e. Runoffs:			
1. On joining seams, when resulting in an open seam, score as "open seam".			
2. On binding stitching:			
- 1/4 to 1/2 inch inclusive		X	
- over 1/2 inch.	X		
f. Seam and stitch types:			
1. Not specified seam or stitch type.		X	
2. Looper thread on outside (when 401 stitch is used).	X		
3. Chain of 101 stitch type exposed on outside of hat.	X		
g. Stitch tension:			
1. Loose tension resulting in a loose seam.		X	
2. Loose tension on top quilting stitches or edge stitching, resulting in loosely exposed lower thread or top thread.		X	
3. Tight tension (stitches break when strain is applied to the direction of seam.)	X		
h. Stitches per inch (to be scored only when the condition exists on major portion of seam or stitching):			
1. Less than minimum specified.		X	
2. More than maximum specified.			X
Shaded parts			
a. Badly shaded parts (except those cut from ends).	X		
b. Parts permitted to be cut from ends badly shaded.			X
Brim			
a. Twisted, stretched, or poorly shaped.	X		
b. Rows of quilting stitches less than 3/16 inch or more than 1/4 inch apart.		X	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Defects	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Brim (cont'd)			
c. Needle thread of quilting stitching finished on underside of brim.			X
d. Fullness between rows of quilting stitches.		X	
e. Binding, twisted, puckered, or pleated.	X		
f. Outside end of binding not turned under or not within 1/2 inch of center back of brim.			X
g. Binding finished more than 3/8 inch wide on top of brim for a distance of 2 inches or more.		X	
h. Irregular in width by more than 1/2 inch inclusive.		X	
i. Ends of binding lapped less than 1/2 inch.		X	
j. Brim curving upward less than 3/4 inch or more than 1 inch (type I and type III hats), or less than 1 inch or more than 1-1/8 inches (type II hat).		X	
Crown and sides			
a. Crown twisted or distorted.		X	
b. Side twisted or distorted.	X		
c. Side lining twisted or distorted.			X
d. Lining extending below edge of brim.			X
e. Camouflage band bartacks positioned less than 1-1/8 or more than 1-3/8 inches apart.			X
f. Camouflage band attached to side with less than 1/8 inch or more than 1/4 inch fullness.		X	
g. Ends of camouflage band not caught in back seam stitching.	X		
h. Camouflage band bartacks insecure.			X
i. Camouflage band bartacks not positioned across width of band.		X	
j. Camouflage band bartack measuring less than 1/2 inch or more than 5/8 inch.			X
k. Camouflage band bartack measuring more than 3/32 inch wide.			X
l. Camouflage band bartack extending beyond edge of webbing.			X
m. Side back seam and side lining back seam not seam on seam, by more than 1/8 inch.		X	
n. Stitches joining top side to crown exposed on inside of hat.		X	
o. Stitches joining side lining to crown exposed on outside of hat.		X	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Defects	Classification Major	Minor A	Minor B
Crown and sides (cont'd)			
p. Joining seam of top side to bottom side out of alignment by more than 1/16 inch at back seam.		X	
q. Camouflage band off center of bottom side piece by more than 1/8 inch.			X
Chin strap and keeper			
a. Chin strap missing.	X		
b. End of chin strap not fused.		X	
c. Keeper missing.	X		
d. Keeper less than 5/8 inch or more than 7/8 inch long; or less than 3/8 inch or more than 5/8 inch wide.			X
e. Holes in keeper too small or too large not permitting chin strap to function properly, i.e., falls freely from set position or keeper immovable.	X		
f. Chin strap measuring less than 24 inches or more than 26 inches long.			X

* 4.2.3 End item dimensional examination. The end item shall be examined for conformance to the measurements in table III. Any dimension not within the specified tolerance shall be classified as a defect. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one hat. The sample unit shall be one hat. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 4.0.

* 4.2.4 Packaging inspection. An examination shall be made to determine that the preservation, packing, and marking comply with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Examine	Defect
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling, or improper taping. Bulged or distorted container. Polyethylene bags heat sealed seams open, noncontinuous or crooked. Incorrectly fabricated bag.
Content	Number of intermediate packs per shipping container is more or less than required. Number of hats per intermediate pack is more or less than required. 1/ Type shown on one or more hats not as specified on shipping container.

1/ For this defect, one intermediate pack from each shipping container in the sample shall be examined.

* 4.2.5 Palletization examination. An examination shall be made to determine that the palletization complies with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance wtih the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds maximum requirements.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

5. PACKAGING

* 5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packing. Each hat shall be firmly rolled along the lengthwise dimension of the hat. Each hat shall be inserted into a snug-fitting

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

polyethylene bag. The polyethylene bag shall be flat style, made from clear polyethylene film of 0.00125 inch thickness (± 25 percent tolerance). The bag may be fabricated from polyethylene film tubing or sheeting. The bag shall be formed with heat sealed seams that are straight, continuous and parallel to each other and the formed edges of the bag. The final closure of the bag shall be heat sealed with the seal made as close as possible to the open end. Alternatively, bag closure may be accomplished by a twist tie method. Prior to or during the closure operation, excess air within the bag shall be expelled.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packing. Twelve hats of one description only, unit packed as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be placed in an intermediate fiberboard box conforming to style FOL (end-opening), grade W6c or W6s of PPP-B-636. Level A packages shall be placed flat one in length, one in width and twelve in depth. Inside dimensions of the fiberboard box shall be 14-1/2 inches in length, 4 inches in width and 13 inches in depth. Each fiberboard box shall be closed in accordance with method IV as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

* 5.1.2 Commercial. The hats shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

* 5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

* 5.2.1 Level A packing. One hundred and forty-four hats of one description only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. Level A intermediate packs shall be packed three in length, four in width, and one indepth. Inside dimensions of each container shall approximate 44 inches in length, 16-1/2 inches in width and 14 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed and waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.4. Toward the end of the contract, or when there are less than the required amount per container of the same size, mixed sizes of one description only, may be packed in the same shipping container.

* 5.2.2 Level B packing. One hundred and forty-four hats of one description only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Level A intermediate packs shall be packed three in length, four in width, and one in depth. Inside dimensions of each container shall approximate 44 inches in length, 16-1/2 inches in width and 14 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.2.4. Toward the end of the contract, or when there are less than the required amount per container of the same size, mixed sizes of one description only, may be packed in the same shipping container.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

* 5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard container. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method V as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspecton shall be in accordance with 4.2.4.

* 5.2.3 Commercial packing. Hats preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

* 5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), hats, packed as specified in 5.2, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means K and L or film bonding means O or P. Pallet pattern shall be number 85 in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course.

* 5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, intermediate packs, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

* 5.4.1 Labels, mixed sizes. Each shipping container packed with mixed sizes shall have securely attached to the end and side, directly under the printing or stenciling, a white paper label 5 by 4-inches with the words "MIXED NSN'S" plainly stamped or printed thereon and under these words shall be legibly stamped or printed the correct quantity, type and NSN'S contained therein.

5.4.2 Polyethylene bagged unit packs. Polyethylene bagged unit packs shall have the required identification information legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit ready identification.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The hat is intended for use by male military personnel of the Department of Defense for special purposes in tropical and semi-tropical areas.

* 6.2 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following: .

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. Type and size required (see 1.2).
c. Selection of applicable levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
d. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are requried for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

e. When palletization is required (see 5.3).

6.3 Sample and shade samples. For access to sample of the hat and shade samples of the materials, address the contracting activity issuing the invitatin for bids.

6.4 Source for ventilators with washers. Screen type ventilators with washers may be obtained from Stimpson Co., 900 Sylvan Ave., Bayport, New York 11705.

6.5 Changes from previous issue. The margins of this document were marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, modification, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

Review activities:

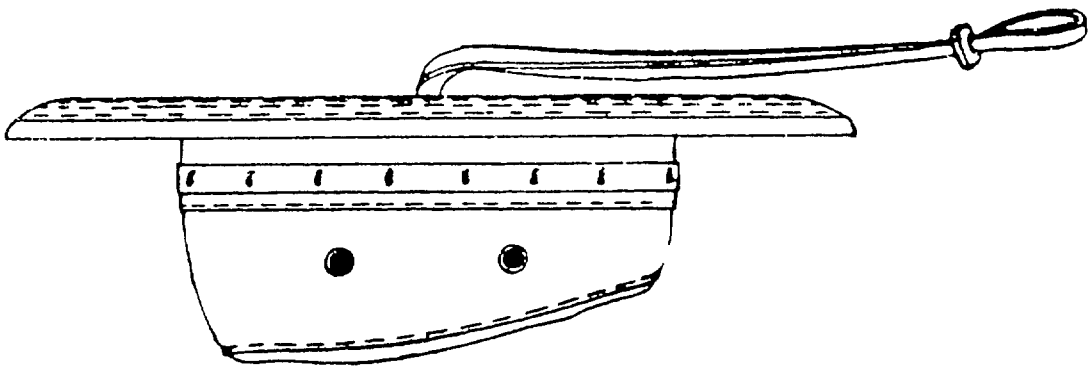
Army - MD
Navy - MS, MC
Air Force - 82, 45
DLA - CT

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project NO. 8415-0413

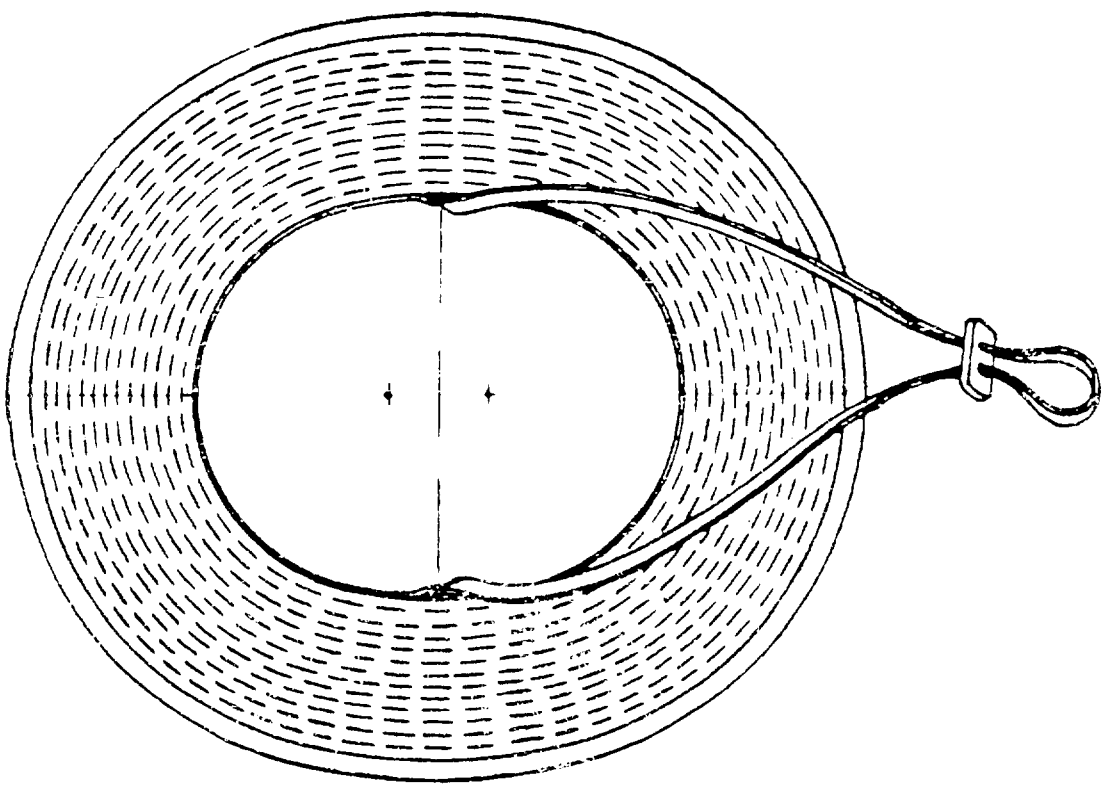
Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



SIDE VIEW

REAR

FRONT



INSIDE VIEW

FIGURE 1, HATS, SUN, HOT WEATHER

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

[illegible] ADDRESSED: Recipient activity should be cited in the Preparing Activity block, this form, provide this form for use in [illegible] comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide [illegible]. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the open edge (DO NOT STAPLE), and [illegible]. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

US ARMY NATICK RESEARCH
and DEVELOPMENT CENTER
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Natick, MA 01760-5014

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

NO POSTAGE
NECESSARY
IF MAILED
IN THE
UNITED STATES

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 12062 WASHINGTON D. C.
POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

Commander
US Army Natick Research
and Development Center
ATTN: STRNC-ES
Natick, MA 01760-5014

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-H-43577D	Hats, Sun, Hot Weather

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

NATICK/HP 20 Nov 87

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:45Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.